

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Why Do We Itch?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 13

No.	Sentence
1	A presenter says she sometimes feels itchy for _____.
2	The expert names two examples of things scratching can remove from the skin: _____.
3	People tend to scratch the _____ where they feel the itch.
4	Removing the unwanted thing helps prevent harm; this gives scratching a _____ role.
5	Researchers asked whether merely _____ about itching might make people feel itchier.
6	In their study, participants watched _____ of itching and scratching.
7	After watching, participants felt _____.
8	The study also recorded _____ scratching by participants.

11 **What is the main benefit of scratching in the skin expert's account?**

- A It identifies the exact source of an itch.
- B It clears potentially harmful things from the skin.
- C It prevents every future contact with parasites.
- D It makes the skin stop noticing unfamiliar objects.

12 **What question did the researchers set out to explore?**

- A Whether itchy clothing changes how people think.
- B Whether parasites can be seen in a video recording.
- C Whether scratching removes objects from the skin faster.
- D Whether thinking about itching can increase itchy feelings.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What did the video study show about its participants?**
- A They felt itchier and scratched more without prompting.
 - B They felt itchier but deliberately avoided scratching.
 - C They scratched more only after receiving instructions.
 - D They scratched less although they felt equally itchy.
- 14 **What does the expert's phrase "catch a scratch" suggest in this study?**
- A Scratching directly transfers a skin parasite.
 - B A person needs physical contact to begin scratching.
 - C Seeing scratching can trigger an urge to scratch.
 - D An itchy feeling always spreads through conversation.
- 15 **Which contrast best captures the two experts' findings?**
- A One explains the cause of every itch; the other disproves that cause.
 - B One describes a protective action; the other finds a response to what people see.
 - C One studies skin damage; the other shows that scratching repairs damaged skin.
 - D One rules out outside triggers; the other identifies a parasite in the videos.